

REMEMBER LAST YEAR?

Tribe Again Faces
A.A. Opener as an
Unrated Outfit

By LESTER KOELLING
The Indianapolis Indians, in their first year of affiliation with the Chicago White Sox, will go to the post in the 1957 American Association pennant race at 7:45 tomorrow night with little or no preseason predictions for a first-division finish.

But that makes no never in the A.A., will draw the opening-game mound assignment, Manager Cohen still favored strongly to Barry Leman, the 20-year-old right-hander who was so outstanding in exhibition games.

The defending champion Indians face the '57 starting gate with only two holdover members following the wholesale sweep of talent by Cleveland in closing out its five-year ownership and working agreement with Indianapolis. They are Outfielder Ted Beard and Pitcher George Spencer, both owned by Indians, Inc.

But the 1957 Indianapolis club will have several faces familiar to Victory Field fans, including Tony Ponce, a pitcher with Louisville last season; Vince Garcia, an infielder, and Charley Bicknell, a pitcher with both Toledo and Wichita, and Sam Hairston, a catcher with Charleston in 1954.

A day-long "salute to the Indians" is planned here tomorrow. At noon there will be a colorful and music-packed parade over principal downtown streets—south on Pennsylvania from Michigan to Washington, west on Washington to Meridian, north around the west segment of Monument Circle, then to North Street to disband.

In the 100 units of the "biggest ever" baseball parade organized by the Junior Chamber of Commerce will be the Indians—with Miss Universe beauty contestants at their side—and Minneapolis Millers players, floats, school bands, military units, Shrine Horse Patrol, youth groups and government dignitaries.

The Jaycees also will be in charge of program ceremonies at 7:15. Prior to that—from 6:45 to 7:15—Art Hode and his age Distland band will entertain at home plate.

Still climbing toward the \$100,000 advance sale goal, the Indians front office today reported an advance sale of nearly \$65,000. This is the biggest preseason sale in the history of Indianapolis baseball.

Manager Red Davis, new skipper of the Indians, indicated that Stu Miller, a Hatterball hurler who has been with several clubs

in the last 31 home openers and their first in three years tomorrow night when Minneapolis provides the opposition in the American Association lid-lifter. The record since 1927 follows:
1927—St. Paul 1, Indianapolis 0
1928—Indianapolis 5, Minneapolis 4 (13 innings)
1929—Indianapolis 10, Milwaukee 6
1930—Indianapolis 3, Kansas City 2
1931—St. Paul 8, Indianapolis 3
1932—Indianapolis 4, Minneapolis 3 (12 innings)
1933—Indianapolis 3, Milwaukee 2 (14-inning tie)
1934—Indianapolis 4, Toledo 2
1935—Indianapolis 7, Columbus 6
1936—Indianapolis 2, Kansas City 2 (13-inning tie)
1937—Indianapolis 5, Columbus 0
1938—Indianapolis 5, Minneapolis 4
1939—Indianapolis 5, Kansas City 2
1940—Indianapolis 3, St. Paul 2
1941—Indianapolis 3, Milwaukee 0
1942—Columbus 13, Indianapolis 2
1943—Indianapolis 9, Toledo 0
1944—Indianapolis 4, Toledo 0
1945—Indianapolis 9, Columbus 1
1946—Indianapolis 10, Toledo 4
1947—Indianapolis 6, Toledo 3 (11 innings)
1948—Indianapolis 6, Kansas City 2
1949—Indianapolis 8, Kansas City 2
1950—Indianapolis 4, Toledo 3 (11 innings)
1951—Indianapolis 7, Milwaukee 3
1952—Indianapolis 10, Toledo-Charleston 4
1953—Indianapolis 3, Charleston 2
1954—Indianapolis 3, Toledo 1
1955—Minneapolis 5, Indianapolis 0
1956—Omaha 8, Indianapolis 7

ROGER HOWARD, one of the pitchers assigned to Indianapolis by the Chicago White Sox over the week end, is a graduate of Michigan State where he won nine games and lost two in two years before signing with the Chinx. He was a four-sport athlete in high school at Johnstown, Pa., and on graduation had 15 offers of college football scholarships.

"I chose Michigan State because it was the only one that a combination football-baschell scholarship," says Roger. "I liked football, but I thought I had a better chance of making a livelihood out of baseball."

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THE
BULLPEN
By Lester Koelling

HOME, SWEET HOME

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